ENGLISH B2 · ADVANCED GRAMMAR

Causative have and get

Use have or get something done for arranged services and have or get someone to act for personal causation. The lesson connects form, meaning, register and real editorial decisions rather than treating the pattern as an isolated rule.

THE CENTRAL IDEA

Use causative have and get to show that the subject arranges, persuades or experiences an action rather than performing it directly while preserving the intended meaning and register.

Use have or get something done for arranged services and have or get someone to act for personal causation.

MODEL

We had the contract reviewed before signing it.

have/get + object + participle | have + person + base | get + person + to-infinitive

6 GUIDED STAGES · 30 LEARNING DECISIONS

This complete guide combines explanation, visual reasoning, practice and feedback. Separate exercise and answer-key editions are also available from the lesson page.

LEARNING OUTCOMES

OUTCOME 1

01

Recognise the main causative have and get patterns in authentic contexts.

OUTCOME 2

02

Choose a form that accurately expresses show that the subject arranges, persuades or experiences an action rather than performing it directly.

OUTCOME 3

03

Avoid errors that change time, agency, emphasis or speaker commitment.

OUTCOME 4

04

Use the structure appropriately in services, project coordination, everyday arrangements and incident description.

Build meaning before form

Use have or get something done for arranged services and have or get someone to act for personal causation.

What causative have and get communicates

Use have or get something done for arranged services and have or get someone to act for personal causation.

The central purpose is to show that the subject arranges, persuades or experiences an action rather than performing it directly. A successful choice therefore preserves the proposition while making the intended relationship, viewpoint or degree of commitment visible to the reader.

We had the contract reviewed before signing it.	an action arranged for another person to perform
She got the supplier to replace the damaged units.	successfully persuading or arranging for a person to act
He had his laptop stolen on the train.	an event experienced by the subject, often unwillingly

How the pattern is built

Use this working formula: have/get + object + participle | have + person + base | get + person + to-infinitive. The formula is a decision path: it identifies the trigger, the clause architecture and the element that carries tense or modality.

The model “We had the contract reviewed before signing it.” shows the complete pattern in context. Rebuild the sentence from meaning to form instead of translating each word independently.

Choice	Structure	Example
Arranged service	have + object + past participle	We had the contract reviewed before signing it.
Persuaded action	get + person + to-infinitive	She got the supplier to replace the damaged units.
Unwanted experience	have + object + participle	He had his laptop stolen on the train.

Choose by meaning, not by surface similarity

Neighbouring structures may contain similar words but perform different jobs. Compare the three reference patterns and name the intended effect before completing the sentence.

A reliable answer explains both why the chosen form works and why a plausible alternative would change the meaning, time relation, information focus or level of certainty.

Meaning	Best route
an action arranged for another person to perform	Arranged service
successfully persuading or arranging for a person to act	Persuaded action
an event experienced by the subject, often unwillingly	Unwanted experience

Register, discourse and editorial control

This grammar is especially useful in services, project coordination, everyday arrangements and incident description. Its value comes from helping the reader process a relationship efficiently, not from making the sentence sound artificially complex.

After editing, check recoverability, natural word order and consistency with the surrounding paragraph. If the marked structure creates ambiguity, return to a fuller or more neutral clause.

Reason through the pattern

The visual map moves from communicative purpose to structural trigger, then to the final clause. It keeps meaning and form visible at the same time so the learner can justify every choice.

01	02	03	04	05	06	07	08	09
have/get	object	participle	have	person	base	get	person	to-infinitive

DECIDE IN THIS ORDER

STEP 1

Decision 1

Identify the communicative purpose before selecting a form: show that the subject arranges, persuades or experiences an action rather than performing it directly.

STEP 2

Decision 2

Locate the structural trigger and match it to one of the reference patterns.

STEP 3

Decision 3

Check time reference, clause relationships, agency and speaker commitment.

STEP 4

Decision 4

Read the complete sentence in context and confirm that its register suits services, project coordination, everyday arrangements and incident description.

STEP 5

Decision 5

Compare the result with a neutral alternative and keep the marked form only when it adds useful meaning.

Compare forms and meanings

Use the table to justify each structural choice.

Pattern	Form	Model
Arranged service	have + object + past participle	We had the contract reviewed before signing it.
Persuaded action	get + person + to-infinitive	She got the supplier to replace the damaged units.
Unwanted experience	have + object + participle	He had his laptop stolen on the train.

EXAMPLES AT A GLANCE

We had the contract reviewed before signing it.	an action arranged for another person to perform
She got the supplier to replace the damaged units.	successfully persuading or arranging for a person to act
He had his laptop stolen on the train.	an event experienced by the subject, often unwillingly

COMMON ERRORS

EDIT THIS

Avoid this pattern

Do not use the base verb after the object in the service pattern.

EDIT THIS

Avoid this pattern

Do not omit to after get plus person.

EDIT THIS

Avoid this pattern

Do not assume every causative have sentence describes a voluntary service.

Recognition in context

Choose the sentence whose grammar matches the stated communicative purpose.

A1 · MEANING DECISION 1

Which sentence best communicates this purpose: an action arranged for another person to perform?

OPTIONS We had the contract reviewed before signing it. · She got the supplier to replace the damaged units. · He had his laptop stolen on the train.

A2 · MEANING DECISION 2

Which sentence best communicates this purpose: successfully persuading or arranging for a person to act?

OPTIONS She got the supplier to replace the damaged units. · He had his laptop stolen on the train. · We had the contract reviewed before signing it.

A3 · MEANING DECISION 3

Which sentence best communicates this purpose: an event experienced by the subject, often unwillingly?

OPTIONS He had his laptop stolen on the train. · We had the contract reviewed before signing it. · She got the supplier to replace the damaged units.

A4 · INTERPRETATION 4

What does “We had the contract reviewed before signing it.” communicate in this context?

OPTIONS an action arranged for another person to perform · successfully persuading or arranging for a person to act · an event experienced by the subject, often unwillingly

A5 · INTERPRETATION 5

What does “She got the supplier to replace the damaged units.” communicate in this context?

OPTIONS successfully persuading or arranging for a person to act · an event experienced by the subject, often unwillingly · an action arranged for another person to perform

A6 · INTERPRETATION 6

What does “He had his laptop stolen on the train.” communicate in this context?

OPTIONS an event experienced by the subject, often unwillingly · an action arranged for another person to perform · successfully persuading or arranging for a person to act

STAGE CHECK

Pause before continuing

Underline the trigger or decision point, name the rule, and check that the meaning has not changed.

Form and function

Identify both the structural family and the meaning carried by each model.

B1 · FORM AND FUNCTION 1

"We had the contract reviewed before signing it." uses _____ to express _____.

OPTIONS Gap 1: Arranged service / Persuaded action / Unwanted experience · Gap 2: an action arranged for another person to perform / successfully persuading or arranging for a person to act / an event experienced by the subject, often unwillingly

B2 · FORM AND FUNCTION 2

"She got the supplier to replace the damaged units." uses _____ to express _____.

OPTIONS Gap 1: Persuaded action / Unwanted experience / Arranged service · Gap 2: successfully persuading or arranging for a person to act / an event experienced by the subject, often unwillingly / an action arranged for another person to perform

B3 · FORM AND FUNCTION 3

"He had his laptop stolen on the train." uses _____ to express _____.

OPTIONS Gap 1: Unwanted experience / Arranged service / Persuaded action · Gap 2: an event experienced by the subject, often unwillingly / an action arranged for another person to perform / successfully persuading or arranging for a person to act

STAGE CHECK

Pause before continuing

Underline the trigger or decision point, name the rule, and check that the meaning has not changed.

Guided discourse choices

Maintain accurate form and meaning across a connected sequence of decisions.

C1 · EDITORIAL PLANNING

Choose the model that expresses an action arranged for another person to perform: _____. Choose the model that expresses successfully persuading or arranging for a person to act: _____. Choose the model that expresses an event experienced by the subject, often unwillingly: _____. Choose the model built with have + object + past participle: _____. Choose the model built with get + person + to-infinitive: _____. Choose the model built with have + object + participle: _____.

_____
_____

WORD BANK

Available forms

He had his laptop stolen on the train. · She got the supplier to replace the damaged units. · We had the contract reviewed before signing it.

STAGE CHECK

Pause before continuing

Underline the trigger or decision point, name the rule, and check that the meaning has not changed.

Open reconstruction

Recover the missing structural trigger without a word bank.

D1 · INDEPENDENT RECONSTRUCTION

We _____ before signing it. She _____ the damaged units. He _____ on the train. State the full structural pattern for Arranged service: _____. State the full structural pattern for Persuaded action: _____.

_____
_____
_____
_____

STAGE CHECK

Pause before continuing

Underline the trigger or decision point, name the rule, and check that the meaning has not changed.

Controlled transformation

Rewrite the neutral source so that it performs the requested advanced function.

E1 · TRANSFORMATION 1

Rewrite “A specialist reviewed the contract for us.” using the Arranged service pattern to express an action arranged for another person to perform.

_____
_____

E2 · TRANSFORMATION 2

Rewrite “She persuaded the supplier to replace the units.” using the Persuaded action pattern to express successfully persuading or arranging for a person to act.

_____
_____

E3 · TRANSFORMATION 3

Rewrite “Someone stole his laptop while he was on the train.” using the Unwanted experience pattern to express an event experienced by the subject, often unwillingly.

_____
_____

E4 · TRANSFORMATION 4

Rewrite “A specialist reviewed the contract for us.” using the Arranged service pattern to express an action arranged for another person to perform.

_____
_____

STAGE CHECK

Pause before continuing

Underline the trigger or decision point, name the rule, and check that the meaning has not changed.

Communicative production

Use the grammar independently in realistic academic, professional and conversational contexts.

F1 · PRODUCTION TASK 1

Write two connected sentences about a realistic situation. Use Arranged service to express an action arranged for another person to perform, then add a neutral sentence that makes the contrast clear.

_____
_____
_____

F2 · PRODUCTION TASK 2

Write two connected sentences about a realistic situation. Use Persuaded action to express successfully persuading or arranging for a person to act, then add a neutral sentence that makes the contrast clear.

_____
_____
_____

F3 · PRODUCTION TASK 3

Write two connected sentences about a realistic situation. Use Unwanted experience to express an event experienced by the subject, often unwillingly, then add a neutral sentence that makes the contrast clear.

_____
_____
_____

07 · RETRIEVAL

Final self-check

Complete these prompts without reopening the guide.

R1 · REVIEW FOCUS

Explain and exemplify: communicative purpose.

_____
_____
_____

R2 · REVIEW FOCUS

Explain and exemplify: structural trigger.

_____
_____
_____

R3 · REVIEW FOCUS

Explain and exemplify: meaning contrast.

_____
_____
_____

R4 · REVIEW FOCUS

Explain and exemplify: register choice.

_____
_____
_____

Recognition in context

Compare the form first, then read the explanation and name the rule in your own words.

A1

We had the contract reviewed before signing it.

Arranged service is the best match because an action arranged for another person to perform.

A2

She got the supplier to replace the damaged units.

Persuaded action is the best match because successfully persuading or arranging for a person to act.

A3

He had his laptop stolen on the train.

Unwanted experience is the best match because an event experienced by the subject, often unwillingly.

A4

an action arranged for another person to perform

The Arranged service pattern communicates an action arranged for another person to perform.

A5

successfully persuading or arranging for a person to act

The Persuaded action pattern communicates successfully persuading or arranging for a person to act.

A6

an event experienced by the subject, often unwillingly

The Unwanted experience pattern communicates an event experienced by the subject, often unwillingly.

Form and function

Compare the form first, then read the explanation and name the rule in your own words.

B1

Arranged service / an action arranged for another person to perform

The structure belongs to the Arranged service pattern. Its communicative purpose is an action arranged for another person to perform.

B2

Persuaded action / successfully persuading or arranging for a person to act

The structure belongs to the Persuaded action pattern. Its communicative purpose is successfully persuading or arranging for a person to act.

B3

Unwanted experience / an event experienced by the subject, often unwillingly

The structure belongs to the Unwanted experience pattern. Its communicative purpose is an event experienced by the subject, often unwillingly.

Guided discourse choices

Compare the form first, then read the explanation and name the rule in your own words.

C1

We had the contract reviewed before signing it.

Arranged service: have + object + past participle.

C2

She got the supplier to replace the damaged units.

Persuaded action: get + person + to-infinitive.

C3

He had his laptop stolen on the train.

Unwanted experience: have + object + participle.

C4

We had the contract reviewed before signing it.

Arranged service: have + object + past participle.

C5

She got the supplier to replace the damaged units.

Persuaded action: get + person + to-infinitive.

C6

He had his laptop stolen on the train.

Unwanted experience: have + object + participle.

Open reconstruction

Compare the form first, then read the explanation and name the rule in your own words.

D1

had the contract reviewed

Arranged service requires “had the contract reviewed” in this model. have + object + past participle.

D2

got the supplier to replace

Persuaded action requires “got the supplier to replace” in this model. get + person + to-infinitive.

D3

had his laptop stolen

Unwanted experience requires “had his laptop stolen” in this model. have + object + participle.

D4

have + object + past participle

Arranged service is built as have + object + past participle.

D5

get + person + to-infinitive

Persuaded action is built as get + person + to-infinitive.

Controlled transformation

Compare the form first, then read the explanation and name the rule in your own words.

E1

We had the contract reviewed before signing it.

have + object + past participle. The rewrite preserves the core message while adding the intended arranged service effect.

E2

She got the supplier to replace the damaged units.

get + person + to-infinitive. The rewrite preserves the core message while adding the intended persuaded action effect.

E3

He had his laptop stolen on the train.

have + object + participle. The rewrite preserves the core message while adding the intended unwanted experience effect.

E4

We had the contract reviewed before signing it.

have + object + past participle. The rewrite preserves the core message while adding the intended arranged service effect.

Communicative production

Compare the form first, then read the explanation and name the rule in your own words.

F1

We had the contract reviewed before signing it. The surrounding context would then state the same situation in neutral order or with a less marked commitment.

A strong response uses have + object + past participle accurately and makes the communicative purpose visible in context.

F2

She got the supplier to replace the damaged units. The surrounding context would then state the same situation in neutral order or with a less marked commitment.

A strong response uses get + person + to-infinitive accurately and makes the communicative purpose visible in context.

F3

He had his laptop stolen on the train. The surrounding context would then state the same situation in neutral order or with a less marked commitment.

A strong response uses have + object + participle accurately and makes the communicative purpose visible in context.

Diagnose the pattern, not only the score

Use this page to decide what to revisit in the complete guide.

CHECK · TRIGGER OR CONTEXT

What went wrong? What rule will prevent the same error next time?

_____
_____
_____

CHECK · AUXILIARY OR STRUCTURAL CHOICE

What went wrong? What rule will prevent the same error next time?

_____
_____
_____

CHECK · MAIN VERB OR CLAUSE FORM

What went wrong? What rule will prevent the same error next time?

_____
_____
_____

CHECK · MEANING AND REGISTER

What went wrong? What rule will prevent the same error next time?

_____
_____
_____